SEO Requirements for New Website

1. SEO Fields in CMS(Content Management System)

The CMS should provide editable SEO fields for important page types such as:

- Blog pages
- Webinar/product pages
- Speaker pages
- Category pages
- Landing pages

Required fields:

- Meta Title
- Meta Description
- Focus Keyword field for SEO management
- Editable URL Slug
- Canonical URL option where required

Important:Add a Focus Keyword field in the CMS for SEO management. This field is for internal SEO use and should not generate a `<meta name="keywords">` tag.

2. SEO-Friendly URL Structure

Create clean, readable and permanent URLs.

Example:

```
/webinars/fmla-compliance-2026/

/blog/payroll-tax-compliance/

/speaker/jason-dinesen/
```

Requirements:

- Use lowercase URLs.
- Use hyphens between words.
- Avoid unnecessary parameters.

- Avoid unnecessarily long URLs.
- Keep URL structures consistent.

3. Page Titles, Meta Descriptions & Headings

Every important page should allow the SEO team to control:

- Unique SEO title
- Unique meta description

The CMS should not automatically generate duplicate titles or descriptions.

4. 404 Page & Redirect Management

404 Page

Create a custom 404 page that includes:

- Clear "Page Not Found" message
- Homepage link
- Website navigation
- Search option
- Links to important sections

Redirects

Provide a reliable way to create **301 redirects** when URLs change.

Avoid:

- Redirect chains
- Redirect loops
- Redirecting every deleted page to the homepage

5. Robots.txt

Create a properly configured `robots.txt`.

It should:

- Allow crawling of important pages.
- Avoid blocking important CSS/JS resources.
- Prevent unnecessary crawling where appropriate.
- Include the XML sitemap location.

The developer should test robots.txt before launch to ensure important SEO pages are not accidentally blocked.

6. XML Sitemap

Create an automatically updating XML sitemap.

It should contain important indexable URLs such as:

- Blogs
- Webinars
- Speakers
- Categories
- Important landing pages

Do not include:

- 404 URLs
- Redirected URLs
- Noindex URLs
- Duplicate URLs

The sitemap should be submitted to Google Search Console.

7. Canonical Tags & Duplicate URLs

Implement correct canonical tags on important pages.

The website should have one preferred URL for each page.

The developer should prevent duplicate URLs caused by:

- URL parameters
- Filters
- HTTP/HTTPS
- Trailing slashes
- Duplicate content

Canonical URLs should point to the preferred HTTPS version.

8. Website Architecture & Internal Linking

Create a clear website structure.

Example:

Home → Webinars → HR Webinars

Important pages should not be buried deep within the website.

The website should also support internal linking between:

- Blog → Webinar
- Webinar → Related Blog
- Category → Individual Webinars

Avoid orphan pages.

9. Website Speed & Core Web Vitals

The website should be optimized for speed on both mobile and desktop.

Requirements:

- Compress images.
- Use WebP/modern image formats.
- Use responsive images.
- Minify CSS, JavaScript and HTML.
- Reduce unnecessary JavaScript.
- Enable browser caching.
- Enable GZIP/Brotli compression.

Core Web Vitals targets:

- **LCP:** ≤ 2.5 seconds
- **INP:** ≤ 200 ms
- **CLS:** ≤ 0.1

Also monitor FCP, Speed Index and TTFB.

Testing tool:

https://pagespeed.web.dev/

GT Matrix

10. Mobile-Friendly Website

The website must be fully responsive and optimized for mobile.

Check:

- Navigation
- Buttons
- Forms
- Text readability
- Images
- Tables
- Webinar registration
- Popups
- Menus

Important SEO content must be available on both desktop and mobile.

11. Schema Markup

Implement appropriate structured data.

Recommended:

- Organization Schema
- WebSite Schema
- BreadcrumbList Schema
- Article Schema for blogs
- Event Schema for qualifying webinars/events
- Product Schema where appropriate for products

Schema should contain only accurate information that is actually represented on the page.

Validate the schema after implementation.

13. Image SEO

Images should be optimized for both SEO and performance.

Requirements:

- Descriptive image file names
- Meaningful ALT text
- Compressed images
- Appropriate image dimensions
- WebP/modern formats where appropriate

- Lazy loading for non-critical images

Avoid keyword stuffing in ALT text.

14. Google Search Console & Analytics

Before or immediately after launch:

Google Search Console

- Verify the domain.
- Submit XML sitemap.
- Inspect important URLs.
- Monitor indexing.
- Monitor Core Web Vitals.
- Monitor crawl/indexing errors.

Analytics

Set up tracking for:

- Page views
- Webinar registrations
- Purchases
- Form submissions
- Important CTA clicks

15. Based on 2026 Google Updates

- Avoid Doorway Pages (pages only for ranking not have any useful content)
- **FAQ Content and Structured Data**

FAQ sections may be used when they provide useful information to visitors.

However:

- Do not add FAQ schema solely to obtain a Google FAQ rich result.
- If FAQ structured data is used, it must accurately represent FAQ content visible on the page.
- Do not add fake, hidden, or irrelevant FAQs.

Prevent Back-Button Hijacking

The website should not interfere with the browser's Back button.

- Do not prevent users from going back.
- Do not redirect users unexpectedly.
- Test popups, forms, checkout, and third-party scripts.

Image Selection & Search Appearance

Requirements:

- Use the **main/relevant image** for the page as the primary image.
- Use descriptive file names, such as `fmla-ada-workers-comp-2026.jpg` instead of `image123.jpg`.
- Add meaningful **ALT text** that describes the image naturally.
- Use properly sized and optimized images to avoid slowing down the page.
- Make important images **crawlable and accessible** to search engines.
- Do not use the company logo or decorative images as the primary image when a more relevant image is available.
- Set an appropriate `og:image` for social media sharing.

Example: For a webinar page, the **webinar banner** should be treated as the primary image rather than the company logo or speaker photo.

Final Requirement

The website should not launch until the major technical SEO issues have been resolved.

Main Goal

The coder should build the website so that **SEO can be managed from the CMS without requiring a developer for routine SEO changes**.

The website should be:

Crawlable → Indexable → Fast → Mobile-Friendly → Structured → SEO-Editable → Search Engine Ready